

FROM THE DIRECTOR



It am happy to share this latest edition of our e-newsletter for the purpose of sharing the work being done by Janhit Foundation towards environment conservation, sustainable development and social empowerment. It also highlights the cases, awareness meetings and other events organised by Meerut CHILDLINE.

I thank all our members and friends for their great interest and most generous support towards our work. I welcome your suggestions and comments.

A happy reading to everyone!

Anita Rana

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About The Foundation

Janhit Foundation is an independent, not-for-profit non-governmental organization, actively engaged in the promotion of human welfare through environmental protection since 1998.

Key areas of work include:

- **WATER AND SANITATION**
Protection & Preservation of Natural Water Resources
Provision of Potable Drinking Water to Marginalized Communities
Promotion of Safe Hygiene and Sanitation Practices
- **AGRICULTURE**
Promotion of Organic Agriculture
Prevent the Agricultural Use of Chemical Fertilizers and Pesticides
Enhance Livelihoods through Alternative Crop Production
- **CHILD RIGHTS**
Provision of Meerut CHILDLINE Service – a 24/7 helpline for children in distress
Informal Education to Impoverished Slum Communities
Organize and Manage Human Rights Awareness Programs
- **WOMEN HEALTH AND SOCIO ECONOMIC EMPOWERMENT**
Improving the maternal and infant health care.
Capacity building of rural and urban women to improve their personal hygiene
Awareness on female foeticide issue and save the girl child programme
- **ENVIRONMENT**
Environment Education
Conservation and promotion of biodiversity and cultural heritage

Janhit Foundation undertakes this work through scientific research, campaigns, advocacy and grass-root level community involvement. As a public interest organisation, Janhit Foundation focuses on strengthening local communities through their active participation in decision making, to achieve sustainable development.

Inauguration of *Kutte ka Talaab* Revival Project

An initiative supported by Coca Cola India Beverages Pvt. Ltd. and Charities Aid Foundation (CAF), New Delhi

'Kutte ka Talaab' is situated at Chiyana village of Ghaziabad district, apx 1 km from the Lalkaun locality. The pond is said to be historically the tomb of a faithful dog that was mistakenly killed by his master. The pond derives its name from the fact that many people take a dip in the water after having been bitten by a dog. After immersing themselves in the water, people pay obeisance to the idol of the dog and feel relieved of all physical pain and mental trauma. This folklore has also been acknowledged in the book 'Swadhinta Andolan aur Meerut' written by Acharya Deepankar with records providing evidence in the context of the pond from the time of Nal and Damyanti. In the Mughal period, this area was the property of Sayyeds who were courtesans of the King of Delhi.

Janhit Foundation in association with Coca Cola India Beverages Pvt. Ltd. and Charities Aid Foundation has taken up the responsibility of reviving this pond and thus keeping the history of this pond living and the legend alive. Initiating the work at the pond, an inauguration ceremony was organized by JF. The ceremony involved the participation of Janhit's team, representatives from Coca Cola & CAF, and the local administration, the Pradhan of the village and other residents. During the ceremony, Ms. Anita Rana shared the initiatives being undertaken by JF on water conservation. She also briefed the gathering about the activities that would be implemented at the pond. Mr. Prateek Dubey on behalf of Coca Cola shared other programmes of Coca Cola on water conservation. Alongwith the village head Mr. Ravindra Chaudhary, Mr. Amrish Bhati (Block Head) and Sh. Fakeerchand Nagar (District President of Gautambudh Nagar) were also

present at the programme and showed a keen interest in supporting JF in this noble cause.

Ms. Akriti Manchanda and Mr. Manu Sharma from CAF also shared their views. A bhoomi poojan was organised on the occasion and towards the end of the programme JF appealed the villagers to extend their cooperation not only during the restoration but afterwards too by maintaining the pond, to which everyone agreed.



France Student Delegation @ JF

Students of the Paul Eluard School, Paris (France) visited JF to learn about the work of the foundation on water conservation and quality protection, particularly focusing river systems. During the study tour, they visited Kali River flowing through Meerut district and Jaibheem Nagar situated on the bank of the river. They learnt about the river nature, its water quality and causes as well as extent of pollution in the river. At Jaibheem Nagar they studied about the effects of the river pollution on groundwater and human health. JF also shared the other projects and research studies conducted on other rivers and small tributaries of Western Uttar Pradesh. It was a knowledge gaining experience for the students, as told by them.



World Environment Day Celebration

On the occasion of world environment day, an awareness programme was organised at Gesupur village in Bulandshahr by students of Delhi University, Amity University and Indian institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi. During the programme, documentaries on environment conservation and pollution, produced by Janhit Foundation and others were screened. Local environmental problems faced by the villagers at Gesupur were also discussed at the programme. Ms. Anita Rana highlighted the importance of environment conservation at individual level and briefed the children about hygiene and cleanliness.



World Groundwater Day Celebration

'Everyone can and should do something to protect groundwater', was the theme promoted by Janhit Foundation while celebrating the groundwater day at village Mehrauli in Meerut district. Ms. Anita Rana educated the gathering about the growing need to conserve groundwater and stop further depletion of groundwater levels. The programme

became a huge success with the cooperation of villagers and efforts of Janhit team.

Meerut CHILDLINE - New Superman of the town

In yet another shocking incidence of heinous crime of labor, CHILDLINE Meerut rescued a 14 year old girl who was working as a domestic helper. CHILDLINE team was approached by the girl through her neighbor on 1098. The team after the call, immediately took action and did the rescue operation. Upon rescue, the girl revealed that she was originally from Jharkhand and was brought to Meerut via Delhi by a man who lured her of money and work. She was working in that house for a month where she was tortured, beaten and was . She also told that she now living a miserable life. She wanted to go back to her family and so was reunited with her father and sister by team safely. She called Meerut CHILDLINE as her new Superman who rescued her out of the danger.

Foreign Delegation @ Janhit Foundation

Delegation from Ohio University and Tuskegee University along with Sardar Vallabh Bhai Patel Agriculture University, Meerut visited Janhit Foundation to learn about the programmes of the foundation on sustainable agriculture and rural development. After discussion, they were taken for a field visit to village *Khatki*.



CHILDLINE ADVISORY BOARD Meeting

Childline Advisory Board meeting was held at Vikas Bhawan under Chairmanship of CDO Ms. Shubra Saxena at Meerut. The purpose was to share the service agenda of CHILDLINE and discuss the better function of the service in support with local administration. The CDO and other officials of various departments ensured provision of all full assistance and support to Meerut CHILDLINE.



Open House

Meerut CHILDLINE conducted Nukkar Natak to create public awareness on Child Rights and toll free child helpline number 1098 at Bus Stands and other public places of Meerut. Huge gathering assembled at the sites where natak was performed. Discussions were held with the public on illegal child labour activities and importance of child rights. The event and CHILDLINE team was highly appreciated by local administration, Moonlight School and others who were present at the programme.

Rain Centre visit by children of army officials

Children of army officials visited Rain Centre to gain knowledge on issues related to water. At the centre, they learnt about the importance of water conservation, safe drinking water and water quality safeguard. Through a live model at the centre, they also discovered what rainwater harvesting is and how it benefits the groundwater. Janhit Foundation gave them a presentation and to put on their interest during the visit, showed them animated films as well as documentaries. A group discussion was also organised in order to satisfy the queries of eager young minds.

Khap Panchayat Meeting

Discussion on female feticide and its prevention.

Adopting a more liberal attitude towards the womenfolk, the Sarva Khap (all khaps) Panchayat at Jasoi village in Muzaffarnagar district called for a social boycott of parents guilty of female feticide. The women and girls of the village were motivated to move out of their houses and participated in the meeting. They supported panchayat's decision about girls should not be wearing jeans and that mobile use by the girls should be supported. During the discussion, majority from the gathering were of a view that in modern time of connectivity and communication, mobile is an integral part of development alongwith a safety measure if used for constructive purposes. Women expressed their views against the ill practice of feticide. They were educated on the issue by the Director of the foundation and were sensitized to realize the power of being a 'Woman'.



Summer Camp for Slum Children

While the summer heat held all in its unwavering grip, Meerut CHILDLINE determinedly pursued their mission to ensure that the rights of each child are guaranteed and protected. Meerut Child CHILDLINE annually participates in the summer camp conducted by TAP-SEVA-SUMIRAN organization. This year the team facilitated participation of children from various slum areas in the camp. They were encouraged to perform various extra-curricular and sports activities during the camp. Special classes for personality development were also conducted. The purpose was to educate the children through fun activities.

Bhoojal Meeting by CCI

On the occasion of Ground Water Week, UP Chamber of Commerce and Industries organized Bhoojal meeting at Meerut wherein Janhit Foundation was invited to deliver a presentation. Emphasizing on the importance of groundwater, Director of the foundation briefed the gathering about the importance of groundwater in connection to human health and environment. She urged that everyone including the government, policymakers, environmentalists, groundwater professionals, students, farmers and the community people should take initiatives to protect this vital resource. She also discussed the work being promoted by JF on water conservation and rainwater harvesting. The guests at the occasion were Mr. Vinod Kumar, Director CCI Meerut and Mr. S R Rao, Director of Pollution Control Board.

School Chalo Abhiyaan

'School Chalo Abhiyaan' was initiated by JF with an aim to enroll more and more children (6-14 years) in the government primary and upper primary schools and thus encourage them for pursuing education. The children were motivated and approached through nukad natak and one to one awareness about importance of educating.



Visit to Satyakam Care Home

Janhit Foundation visited the Meerut located Satyakam Care Home for children living with HIV/AIDS. The purpose was to celebrate "Give As You Earn" (an initiative supported by Charities Aid Foundation – CAF, New Delhi). Donation of toys and stationary was made to the care home and the day was celebrated by cutting cake and enjoying

Independence Day Celebration

The day was celebrated at the office premises of JF with the participation of children living in slums who performed group dance on patriot songs.



Farewell to Duncan Craig.



Duncan Craig from UK worked with JF this year for a period of nine months as a volunteer. He was given a farewell party before leaving back in the month of November. JF feels happy to share that Duncan has been passionate and enthusiastic while working with the foundation. He extended his immense help and support to the foundation in terms of general project support, monitoring & evaluation, strategic planning, report writing and project management. His contribution has been potential for the organisation and we thank him for working extensively for Indian society at large.

CHILDLINE Task Force at Meerut

The Ministry of Labour and Employment (Government of India) through the National Commission of Child Rights, New Delhi is setting up CHILDLINE Task Force at district level in different states. The goal is to create a society free of child labour for which the layout and details of the task force as formulated by the Commission are being followed in each district. In the same line, a task force (Urban as well as Rural) has been set up at Meerut in order to identify and rescue children working as labourers under the age of 14 years; as termed as adequate legal action in the Child Labour Act, 1986. The task force is being coordinated by Meerut CHILDLINE.

Payjal Meeting by Planning Commission

Janhit Foundation was invited to participate in a meeting organised by Planning Commission at Lucknow to discuss the scenario of water resource degradation and decreasing ground water levels in the state. Another issue discussed during the meeting was effective implementation of new government plans and projects for the benefit of common people through with grassroot level involvement of civil society organisations. Ms. Anita Rana on behalf of the foundation gave her valuable suggestions emphasizing on the importance of rainwater harvesting for sustainable use of water as a resource.

Kisaan Jamawra Panchayat

A national level meeting was organised for the farming community at Delhi to discuss the present scenario of regional agriculture and the economic status of the farmers. The meeting was participated by a number of farmers from across the country alongwith eminent political figures, learned researchers, analysts and civil society organisations including Janhit Foundation. The foundation was invited to share the work it is promoting on sustainable agriculture and organic farming. A documentary produced by JF on the subject was also screened during the meeting which was highly appreciated.



Discussion on Second Green Revolution

Director of Janhit Foundation was invited to participate in a discussion and formulation of a state level strategy plan to deal with the issue of second green revolution, organised by Action Aid at Lucknow. During the discussion, she emphasized on adoption of organic farming activities as vital part of second green revolution in India. Dr. Suman Sahai of Gene Campaign facilitate the discussion.

Maa Tujhe Pranaam

Every year Amar Ujala organizes 'Maa Tuje Pranam' with an objective to provide a platform to the society for showcasing their skills. This year, CHILDLINE participated in this mega event. Awareness on 1098 and child rights was created amongst the participants through nukad natak on child labour. Another performance on the importance of education for the children was given by the team. The event became a huge success and the efforts of the foundation were highly appreciated by the gathering.

My Clean Meerut into action again

Janhit Foundation as a part of the campaign My Clean India, organized a drawing competition in Saraswati Shishu Mandir School to promote the message of clean, green and hygienic Meerut city. Medals and certificates were awarded to the winners. The programme was followed by a visit of Mr. Remco Van Santen, initiator of the campaign to six schools of the city to discuss other activities. While meeting the students, he motivated them about keeping their city clean and appointed two volunteers from each school to take the campaign forward in their school.



Earth Day Celebration

Earth Day was celebrated by the foundation at Meerut Public Girls School. Various events including inter-school debate, quiz and drawing competitions were organized and the winners for each were awarded. In her speech during the programme, Ms. Anita Rana emphasized that caring and protection of mother earth is a primary goal that everyone should follow. She educated the children about global warming and how everyone can save the earth at their individual level.

Seminar on the PROMOTION OF RAINWATER HARVESTING

A seminar was organised by Janhit Foundation in collaboration with Centre for Science and Environment (CSE), New Delhi on the promotion of rainwater harvesting at CCS University (Meerut) campus. The chief guest on the occasion was Sh. Mrityunjay Kumar (Commissioner Meerut) and the other guests were Secretary, Meerut Development Authority, Sh. S S Pundir (Pro Vice Chancellor), Ms. Sushmita (Chief, Water Resource, CSE) and Ms. Anita Rana (Director, Janhit Foundation). The major issue of discussion at the seminar was improving groundwater level through rainwater harvesting and its role in groundwater quality protection. A documentary produced by CSE on the subject was also screened. Students from various schools and colleges participated in the event enthusiastically and made it a huge success.



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Please feel free to write us for any suggestions or comments regarding the newsletter.